

With Bucky Barnes in custody, and Steve Rogers and his crew in holding, a stranger with a nefarious plan takes advantage of the situation. Armed only with a small red book, he sits down for a face-to-face with Bucky under the guise of a psychologist. According to Director Anthony Russo, this stranger—whom we come to know as Helmut Zemo—was morally constructed to be both right and wrong, much like the other characters in the film. "It was very important for us to give Zemo a valid point of view," Russo says. "That was the heart of how we constructed the narrative and the storytelling of this movie—every character has some validity to their point of view. We've always been more excited by villains who do have a valid point of view. We've always found them scarier and more threatening than a villain you can write off as just crazy or unhinged. Zemo is very dangerous and scary—while at the same time being grounded in a relatable way with raw human emotions and experience." It's fitting, then, that the unstable Zemo sets former villain Bucky Barnes back on the warpath, driving away the very humanity he's been fighting to regain since the events of Marvel's *Captain America: The Winter Soldier*. All it takes are a few trigger words from a red codebook, and the Winter Soldier is back on autopilot.

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